

Jack Balster

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EDUCATION

Washington State University

- M.S. Software Engineering
- B.A. Management Information Systems
- Minor Computer Science

Expected Graduation: May 2026

GPA: 3.8

Cum Laude, President's Honor Roll: 8 Semesters

Distinguished Regents Scholar Award Winner

EXPERIENCE & PROJECTS

Full Stack Software Engineer Intern – TORQ Sports (Remote)

2025-Present

Developing a cross-platform mobile app for athlete recruitment & networking

Flutter | Dart | Firebase | Node.js | Express.js

- Designed and built a Flutter based mobile application, integrating with Firebase for authentication and data storage.
- Built responsive and dynamic UIs using Flutter widgets and then styled them with Tailwind CSS for a polished UX.
- Developed and optimized backend APIs using Node.js and Express.js, ensuring seamless dataflow and performance.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams to design and develop features such as user authentication, college connections, and social media-style explore pages.

WSU Tutoring Center Portal

2023

Enhanced and redesigned tutoring portal with expanded features

Python | Django | JavaScript | MySQL | Bootstrap

- Enhanced WSU's tutoring system by expanding the existing portal with new features and a comprehensive UI redesign, reducing scheduling clicks by 4 to streamline the booking process.
- Implemented a multi-role user system which includes students, tutors, and admins each with different access privileges and functionalities within the portal.
- Integrated features such as scheduling appointments based on availability, reviewing tutors, cancelling and viewing appointments, filtering by major, specific classes, or by tutor, creating majors and classes, edit profile, and more.
- Incorporated advanced features such as confirmation emails, password recovery, and extensive tutor reports using ReportLab for statistical analysis of tutors and tutoring sessions.
- **GitHub:** <https://github.com/jack-balster/Tutoring-Portal>

Real-time Chat Platform

2024

Chat app comparable to telegram and iMessage

JavaScript | React | Node.js | Express.js | MongoDB | Tailwind CSS | Firebase

- Developed a comprehensive chat platform to enable efficient and interactive communication between users.
- Implemented user authentication with Firebase and built a responsive front-end using React and Tailwind CSS.
- Enabled real-time communication with Socket.io, allowing users to send messages instantaneously across devices.
- Utilized MongoDB for scalable data storage, management of user profiles, chat histories, and application settings.
- Included key functionalities such as user registration, profile customization, chat room creation, and real-time status updates such as active user indicators, message timestamps, and read receipts.
- **GitHub:** <https://github.com/jack-balster/Real-Time-Chat-Platform>

Facial Recognition Interface

2024

Multi-functional facial recognition system with analytic capabilities

Python | C++ | SQLite | OpenCV | TensorFlow | Docker

- Developed a facial recognition system using advanced machine learning frameworks like TensorFlow and computer vision libraries such as OpenCV.
- Integrated functionalities such as user recognition, emotion detection, gender prediction, and age estimation.
- Designed an intuitive GUI allowing users to train the model and utilize facial recognition features efficiently.
- Containerized the application with Docker, facilitating deployment and scalability across various platforms.
- **GitHub:** <https://github.com/jack-balster/Facial-Recognition-Interface>

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages | C, C++, C#, Python, JavaScript, Dart, HTML, CSS, SQL, VB.NET

Frameworks / Libraries | Flask, React, Node.js, Express.js, Django, Flutter, Pandas, OpenCV, Selenium, Tailwind, Bootstrap

Databases / Tools | PostgreSQL, SQLite, MySQL, MongoDB, Firebase, Git, Docker, Xcode, Android Studio, Azure, VSCode

Data / Networking | Tableau, PowerBI, Data Visualization, TCP/IP Protocols, Network Monitoring, Linux, Windows, MacOS